Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Volume 58 Number 11 Circulation: 1,650 November 2014 Sunnyvale, California Editor: Phyllis Fowler

Monthly Meeting: Wednesday, November 12th
At 7:00 pm at the Lakewood Park Building
Our Topic: Graffiti in our neighborhood

Check out our NEW website: www.lvna.net
Facebook Group page: Lakewood Village LVNA
And Our NEW Facebook page: Lakewood Village LVNA



President's Message

By Fred Fowler

Graffiti Wars Again?

Greetings Neighbors!

Back in the 1990s our neighborhood was plagued by graffiti. Lakewood and Fairwood parks were a mess. The Lakewood Shopping Center (then known as Dick's Market) was covered in tags. Every park bench, bus stop sign and even fire hydrants were "decorated" with spray paint, paint pen marks and other kinds of indelible disfigurements. Even people's cars got tagged.

It got so bad that the City of Sunnyvale started making drastic changes to try to cope with the expense of removing the markings. Many people who were not in Lakewood at the time may not remember that the Lakewood Park building used to have floor-to-ceiling windows in various places. At one point a kind of "key scratch" graffiti became popular and those windows became easy targets. After replacing the glass several times, only to have new marks scratched into their surfaces by the next morning, the Sunnyvale Parks Department decided to "board over" the windows. The park building has been darker and less inviting to be in ever since.

Lately we've grown accustomed to living in a graffiti free environment. Why did the graffiti go away and stay away so long? The answer to the graffiti back then was the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association. The LVNA was re-formed in the early 1990s in order to fight the graffiti problem. . (*Continued on page 4)*

What happened to www.lvna.net?



By Fred Fowler

You may have noticed that our website http://www.lvna.net has been "off the air" for a while. I'm sorry this has taken place, but due to "forces beyond our control" the website went down briefly in September and then went completely dark starting in early October. I've been working to get it back up and running, and with luck it will be available again in a few days. Still, battling those "forces beyond our control" has been quite an experience, and I would like to share it all with you.

The uncontrollable force I'm referring to is AT&T. We've had a DSL line with them for almost 10 years, and that connection has been the one I've used to connect the www.lvna.net server to the internet. The beginning of September marked the beginning of a nightmare of mistakes, broken promises and a run-around that finally drove Phyllis and me to seek another service provider.

It all started one evening when I found that our internet connection was not working. I called the AT&T technical support line and asked what was going on? . (*Continued on page 2)*

What happened to LVNA.net?	2
CNC Classes	3
President's message cont.	4
SCS Holiday Aution	5
Neighborhood Crime Corner	6



Newsletter Walkers Needed for Fairwood Side!

Fred Fowler is looking for a new walker or two. It takes about a half an hour each month.

If interested, please **call Fred Fowler at (408) 505-2813 or email: fmfainc@gmail.com** ◆

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What happened to www.lvna.net?

(*Continued from page 1)*



I was told there was no record of our account in their system and that I would have to call the billing department. When I asked to be transferred, I was told their hours were 9:00am to 5:00pm
Monday through Friday and that the department was currently closed. I would have to call back the next morning.

I delayed going to work the next morning to call during their time window. When I reached a representative (after waiting on hold) I was told our service had been disconnected because of overdue payments.

I then realized that neither Phyllis or I remembered seeing an AT&T bill for some time. Somehow we had been switched to "paperless" billing, and our bills had been going to an AT&T email address that neither Phyllis nor I had checked in the past ten years.

I talked to Phyllis and we made an immediate online payment to bring the account current. I called again the next day, as our service was still not restored. When I reached a representative, he confirmed that payment had been received. The rep said I would hear from them within four hours and that my DSL service would be restored by the end of the day.

The next morning I still had no DSL service. I called and waited on hold again for quite some time. When I finally got through I was told that my phone line had not just been de-activated but completely disconnected. I would have to order completely new phone service. I'm afraid I got a little impatient at that point. After further discussion I was told my service would be restored that evening (it wasn't).

I could go on and on about the endless difficulties I faced. Finally (several days later) I got through to a sympathetic and capable DSL service tech who spent about 15 minutes and restored my DSL service. It had been down for a week.

About three weeks later my DSL service went down again. When I called the billing department, I was told that when my DSL service had been disconnected the first time, the process hadn't been "completed" properly. The had gone back and "tidied things up". I was told that my new order for service was being processed and that I would be contacted by an installation technician by the end of the day.

At that point I told them I would seek internet service elsewhere.

I placed an order for internet service with Sonic.net that day. I must say that working with them was a pleasure after dealing with AT&T. Their service so far has been both fast and trouble free.

Ten days later (last week) we got two letters from AT&T. One was a letter thanking us for our order for "internet service express" and letting us know it would be activated on October 27th.

Continued on page 5)

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Columbia Neighborhood Center

Near Columbia Middle School at 739 Morse Ave.

Drop-in Fitness Room



When: Every Monday & Thursday
Time: 6:30 – 8 pm
When: Every Tuesday
Time: 7:30 – 9 pm
When: Saturdays from
Time: 8 – 9:30 am and 10:30 am to noon
Where: Columbia Neighborhood Center
Cost: $1.00 per participant—cash only

The program is staffed by an attendant who is First Aid and CPR certified. Participants must prove they live in Sunnyvale. Middle School students can participate if accompanied by a parent/guardian. High School students can participate if a parent/guardian signs the waiver/consent form. Forms must be completed before participation. Participants should wear athletic shoes, and bring water and a towel. ◆

Free Legal Clinics

When: First Saturday of the month
Time: 10 am – Noon
Where: Columbia Neighborhood
Cost: Free!

Columbia Neighborhood Center and South Asian Bar Association of Northern California partner to provide free legal clinics. Get a 20 – 30 minute legal consultations on any legal matter, provided by a licensed attorney. ◆

Youth Drop-In Gym



Basketball: Fridays 7 – 10 pm

Indoor Soccer: Mondays 7 – 9 pm
Saturday 7—10 pm
Where: Columbia Neighborhood Center
Cost: 50¢ per visit for residents
($1 for non-residents).



Must be Middle or High School student. **School ID REQUIRED for entry!**

Drop-In Gym will be cancelled if there are no participants in the first hour. ◆

Zumba Classes CNC



When: Wednesdays at 7-8 pm
Fridays from 6-7pm
Where: Columbia Neighborhood Center
Cost: $1.00 per person per visit

Adults and children over 10 years of age. (with an adult/guardian) are invited to participate. There will be no childcare, and children will not be allowed to wait in the gym or lobby because of child endangerment issues parents should not leave their children without adult supervision inside or outside the Center. ◆



Bilingual Story Time

When: Thursday
Time: 4 – 5 pm
Where: Columbia School Library

Fun and games with one of Sunnyvale's bilingual librarians.◆

Library Lending Machine

In the CNC lobby, with books for small children through middle school. You only need a Sunnyvale Library card to use it, and CNC staff can provide you with one. Bring identification and proof of residency. Any SV Library book can be returned in the green bin in the lobby.◆

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Sunday Services
9:30 a.m. Sunday School for all ages
11:00 a.m. Worship Service

Wednesday
7:00 p.m. Corporate Prayer Meeting





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President's Message

(Continued from Page 1)



And fight it we did! Even better, we won! By the late 1990s the graffiti problem was gone. And it has stayed away...*until now*

As anyone who has walked in one of the parks lately can tell you, we're facing a new graffiti attack. Black spray can markings have popped up on the school buildings, the park benches, even the trash containers!

The good news is that we can fight back! Why? Because we *know how to do it*! After all, we've done it before. We know how to fight and win graffiti war.

The key to driving graffiti artists away is to *remove their markings as soon as they appear.* I've heard of graffiti makers being compared to wild animals marking their territory. If a lion or wolf leaves his "calling card" in a particular place and it stays there, the animal feels it has staked an undisputed claim to the surrounding area. Likewise, if a tagger leaves a tag and it stays there, the tagger feels a sense of ownership of the surrounding area.

If a group of people get together and remove tags when they happen, they take away the tagger's sense of owning the territory. In effect the group is *marking the territory as theirs* by removing the other marks. In the 1990s the LVNA organized volunteers to patrol the neighborhood and wash off/paint over tags as soon as they appeared. The leader of the effort was a grandfather named Gene Goldsmith. Gene fitted out a bicycle with brushes and cleaners and donated paint. He would ride around the neighborhood early in the morning and get rid of any tags he saw. He was recognized for his efforts by being selected to carry the Olympic Torch through Sunnyvale on its way to the 1996 Olympic Games in Atlanta.

We fought the graffiti war for several years until one day, quite suddenly, it all stopped. The tags suddenly stopped appearing. They stayed away.We found out later that the kids in our neighborhood had put a stop to it all. They knew who was doing it. They started saying "hey, cut it out. This is a place where people care."

We still care.

Come to the Lakewood Park building on Wednesday, November 12th at 7:00pm for a discussion about what we can do about this new tagging attack. We'll invite someone from Sunnyvale Public Safety to talk with us about how we can work together with them. We'll also ask any "old timers" (like me) who went through the problem in the 1990s to come and share the lessons they learned back then.

If we nip this problem in the bud, we can get back to the graffiti free environment we have all gotten used to. We know how to do it. All we have to do is prove that we care.

I'll see you on Wednesday night! ◆

Family Harvest Program



Free monthly food distribution for families with a child under 18 living at home, and meeting certain income guidelines: maximum household gross monthly income $2,622 (2 people); $3,298 (3 people); $3,975 (4 people).

For more information or to complete an application, bring photo ID, proof of monthly income and proof of all children living in the home to Columbia Neighborhood Center. ◆

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What happened to www.lvna.net?

(*Continued from page 2*)



We were told we would have to register with AT&T to begin using this service but that billing for the service would begin immediately whether we registered or not.

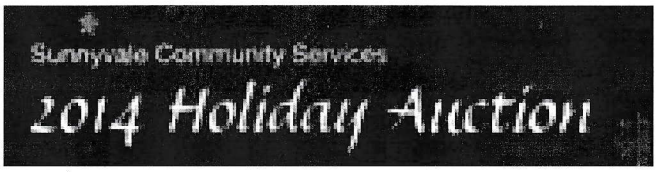
The second letter was another one thanking us for our order for "internet basic service" and letting us know it would be activated on October 28th.

We were once again told we would have to register with **AT&T** before we could use the service, but billing would begin immediately.

Needless to say, we hadn't ordered ANY internet service from **AT&T**. I'm sure I will have to call back during their business hours and wait through a long "on hold" period in order to help them fix these new mistakes of theirs.

The good news is that Phyllis and I have left **AT&T** and these troubles behind us. I'm sorry that www.lvna.net got caught in this nonsensical mess. Now that **Sonic.net** is our internet service provider I think our website will have less trouble staying up.

Thanks for your patience. ◆

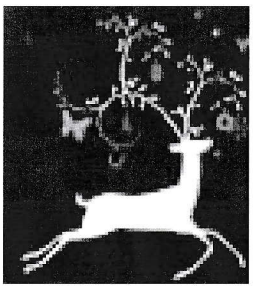


*(In **November** this year!)*

When: Thursday, November 20th
Time: 5:00-7:30 PM
Where: Sunnyvale Elks Lodge
375 N. Pastoria, Sunnyvale

(Please bring an unwrapped toy, $15 gift card for a teen, or a bag of canned food to help fill our Christmas Center.)

Please join us and enjoy food and beverages while bidding on unique live and silent auction items, including vacations, sporting event tickets, spa packages, gifts for the kids, and so much more.



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Neighborhood Crime Corner

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Strong-Arm Robbery – Greenbelt between Morse & Borregas Oct. 24 @ 9:00am
Unknown suspect pushed the victim to the ground while she was walking and stole a gold necklace she was wearing.

Smoke Investigation – 1100 Blk. Stoneylake Ct. Oct. 29 @ 4:41pm
DPS personnel responded on a report of an explosion and a house filled with smoke. Upon arrival, smoke was found throughout the house but no fire was located. Exposed wiring was hanging from the ceiling and it was determined that unpermitted remodeling was occurring and the residence was deemed unsafe.

Possession of Drugs for Sale - 1200 Blk. N. Lawrence Station Rd. Oct.30 @ 1:34am
While officers were checking an alarm at a business, an occupied vehicle was located in the parking lot. Officers contact the occupant of the vehicle and a subsequent search of the vehicle revealed drugs packaged for sale. The occupant was arrested and booked into County Jail.

Burglary – 400 Blk. E. Duane Oct. 7 @ 5:12pm
A resident in the neighborhood reported seeing a subject enter a neighbor's backyard. Upon officers arrival the subject fled on foot. The subject was apprehended.

Burglary – 1100 Blk. Blazingwood Oct. 7 @ 1:30pm
Officers responded to a reported burglary in-progress. Upon arrival two suspects were apprehended and a third fled on foot. The third suspect was subsequently apprehended in the area.

Strong-Arm Robbery – 1158 Morse Oct. 7 @ 3:55pm
while the victim was sitting in her vehicle in the apartment parking lot, an unknown suspect forcibly removed a necklace the victim was wearing.

Robbery – 500 Blk. Lawrence Expressway Oct. 7 @ 9:05pm
While the victim was seated in his vehicle in a parking lot, an unknown suspect broke out a side window of his vehicle and removed a backpack. . The suspect fled to a waiting vehicle. ◆

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Public Safety - Emergency	911
Public Safety - Non-emergency	730-7100
Parks and Maintenance	730-7506
Speeding Cars, parking complaints, traffic signal	Dispatch 730-7180
Noise complaints—Desk Officer	730-7110
Neighborhood Preservation Complaints on decrepit fences, , weeds, illegal home businesses or rentals	730-7610
Animal Control	730-7178
Public Works- sidewalks, trees, streetlights, etc.	730-7505
Nuisance Vehicle Hotline	730-7706
Drug Hotline	245-3784
Graffiti Hotline & Shopping Cart Pickup	730-7680

Street Sweeping:

Fairwood Side - 11/18 & 12/02 & 12/16
Lakewood Side - 11/11 & 11/25 & 12/09

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To submit articles or letters for publication, please contact the editor before the 28th of each month
Send your document or inquiry to Phyllis Fowler: sunnyphyl@gmail.com

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